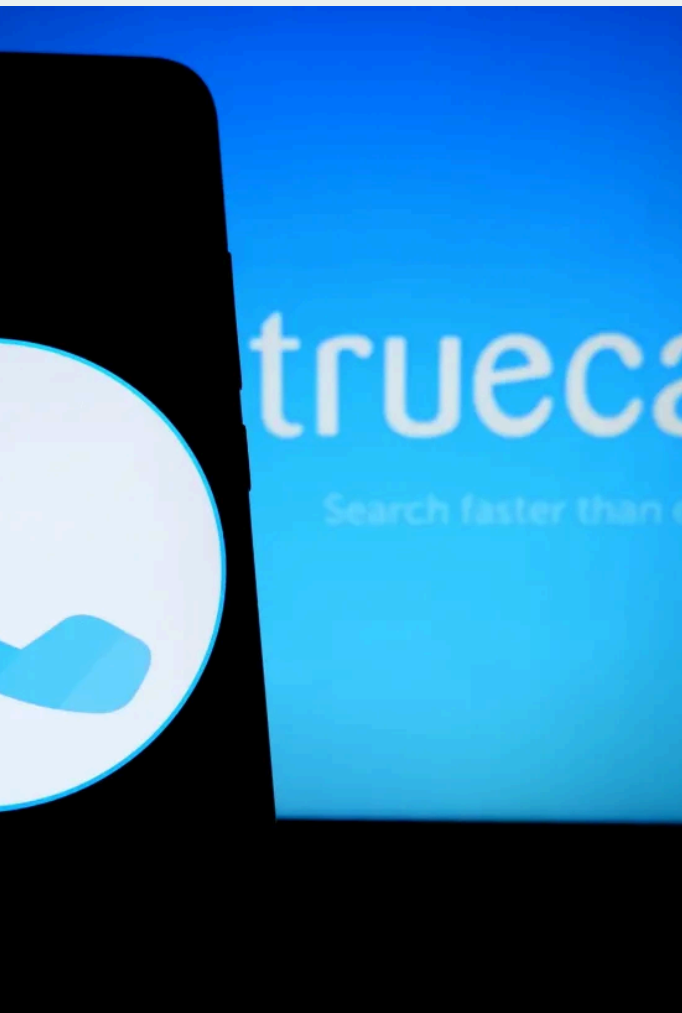


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Truecaller's call-recording feature won't work on iPhones from September 30

Jagmeet Singh — 7:36 AM PDT · August 1, 2025

IMAGE CREDITS:

AVISHEK DAS/SOPA IMAGES/LIGHTROCKET / GETTY IMAGES

Truecaller is discontinuing its call-recording function on iOS — just [over two years after the feature was launched](#) — as the Swedish company opts to focus on its core offering: fighting spam calls.

On Friday, the company confirmed to TechCrunch that its call-recording feature will no longer be available on iPhones starting September 30. Users with saved call recordings can either download them to their devices, share them via email or messaging apps, or switch their storage preference to iCloud to keep the recordings accessible even after the feature is discontinued.

Truecaller’s head of iOS, Nakul Kabra, told TechCrunch the company took the decision because it wanted to focus on its Live Caller ID and automatic spam-blocking features.

In June 2023, Truecaller launched call recording on iOS for its paying subscribers, alongside reintroducing the feature on Android. The app also got support for transcribing calls natively. Both call recording and transcription were [launched](#) in India last year.

While call recording works seamlessly on Android, it is more complicated on iOS, where Apple’s operating system does not let third-party apps record calls natively. To work around this, Truecaller uses a recording line that merges calls to record — a method that increases both costs and complexity, per Kabra. These challenges ultimately led to the feature being discontinued.

The company has [set up a support page](#) to help users if they face any issues during the transition.

Truecaller’s move comes months after Apple introduced native call recording and transcription support for iPhone users in an [iOS 18.1 update](#) last year. The native feature does not require users to connect to a record line to record the call, unlike Truecaller, and also brings Apple Intelligence-powered transcriptions.



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That said, Truecaller had introduced call recording in the first place to entice iPhone users to upgrade, as the caller ID function is limited on the free tier. Paying users also get [real-time caller ID](#), along with advanced and automatic spam blocking, Siri shortcuts, incognito mode, and other features.

Truecaller has around 3 million subscribers worldwide, but iOS accounts for 44% of its total premium revenue, per its [second-quarter financial results](#) (PDF).

Topics: [Apps](#) [call recording](#) [India](#) [iPhone](#) [Truecaller](#) [United States](#)

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Jagmeet Singh

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Jagmeet covers startups, tech policy-related updates, and all other major tech-centric developments from India for TechCrunch. He previously worked as a...

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TeaOnHer, a rival Tea app for men, is leaking users' personal data and driver's licenses

Amanda Silberling, Zack Whittaker

12:40 PM PDT · August 6, 2025

IMAGE CREDITS: TEAONHER (MODIFIED)

TeaOnHer, an app designed for men to share photos and information about women they have supposedly dated, has exposed users' personal information, including government IDs and selfies, TechCrunch can confirm.

The app, which launched on the Apple App Store earlier this week, is a response to another viral app Tea that allows women to post about the men they date. Tea is advertised as a women's safety app with more than 6 million users that is similar to "[Are we dating the same guy?](#)" Facebook networks. However, the app is controversial, since many of the claims that women post cannot be verified.

The backlash surrounding Tea escalated last week, after 404 Media reported 4chan users retaliated by [discovering a publicly exposed database](#) belonging to the app, which [revealed](#) over 72,000 images, including thousands of selfies and photo IDs submitted for account verification. A [subsequent hack](#) exposed more than 1 million private messages sent over the app, prompting the app to [disable](#) its messaging feature.

TeaOnHer, which is now ranked No. 2 among Lifestyle apps on iOS, appears to be a direct rebuttal to the Tea app, even copying the language from Tea's App Store description in its own listing.

But like the app it sought to emulate, TeaOnHer contains security flaws of its own.

TechCrunch has found at least one security flaw that allows anyone access to data belonging to TeaOnHer app users, including their usernames and associated email addresses, as well as driver's licenses and selfies that users uploaded to TeaOnHer. Images of these driver's licenses are publicly accessible web addresses, allowing anyone with the links to access them using their web browser.

In one case, TechCrunch saw a list of posts shared on TeaOnHer appended with each user's email address, display name, and self-reported location.

TechCrunch is withholding some of the details of the bugs so as to not help malicious actors access anyone's data. The app's maker did not respond to emails from TechCrunch asking who we can report the flaws to. As such, TechCrunch is publishing this report with limited details of the issue, given the app's current popularity and the risk faced with using the app.

TeaOnHer was uploaded to the iOS App Store by a developer named Newville Media Corporation. According to LinkedIn, the founder and CEO of this company is Xavier Lampkin.

TechCrunch identified at least one TeaOnHer record associated with Lampkin's own data.

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The security lapse will likely affect any user who signed up or shared identity documents with the app. The bug also exposes the number of users the TeaOnHer app has, which is about 53,000 users at the time of publication.

TechCrunch also identified a potential second security issue, in which an email address and plaintext password belonging to the app’s creator, Lampkin, was left exposed on the server. The credentials appear to grant access to the app’s “admin” panel. TechCrunch did not use the credentials, as doing so would be unlawful, but highlights the risks of inadvertently leaving admin credentials exposed to the web.

Along with its security flaws, the content portrayed within TeaOnHer is troubling in itself. While the app requests IDs and selfies from its users to verify their identities — a process that is not automatic — users can access a “guest” view of the app without signing in.

Immediately upon opening “guest” view, TechCrunch saw several images of the same naked woman, posted under different names in a form of spam. It is not clear if this woman consented to this photo being shared. Other posts share the photos and names of women, alongside comments calling them “easy,” or accusing them of spreading sexually transmitted infections.

Across all free apps, TeaOnHer is ranked No. 17, higher than apps like Instagram, Netflix, Uber, and Spotify. Tea is currently ranked No. 2.

Topics: [apple app store](#) [cybersecurity](#) [data protection](#) [Exclusive](#)

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Amanda Silberling

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Amanda Silberling is a senior writer at TechCrunch covering the intersection of technology and culture. She has also written for publications like Polygon, MTV, the...



Zack Whittaker

Security Editor | 🦋 📧 🏠

Zack Whittaker is the security editor at TechCrunch. He can be reached via encrypted message at zackwhittaker.1337 on Signal. You can also contact him by...

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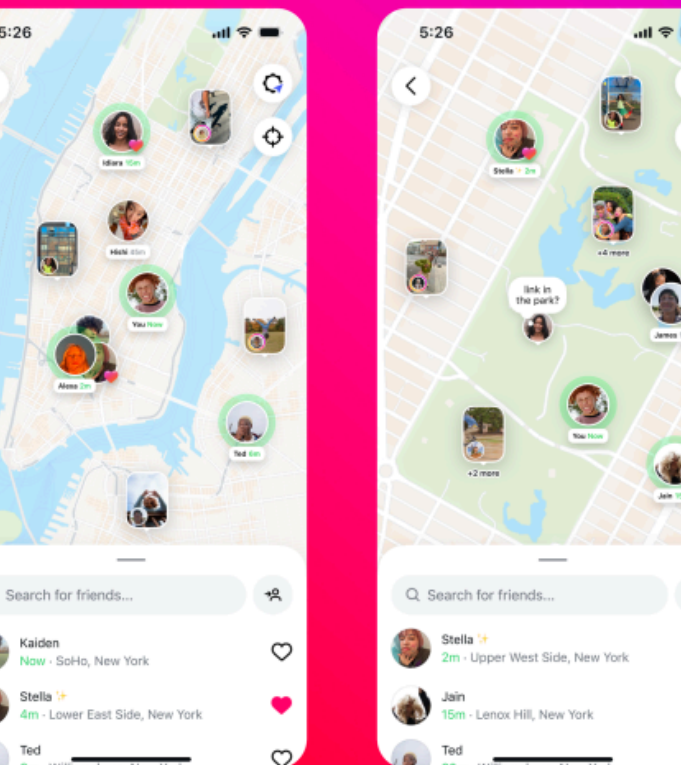


IMAGE CREDITS: INSTAGRAM

APPS



Instagram takes on Snapchat with new ‘Instagram Map’

Aisha Malik — 7:00 AM PDT · August 6, 2025

Instagram is rolling out Instagram Map, a new feature that lets users share their most recent active location with others and discover location-based content. The Meta-owned social network is also launching reposts, and making its “Friends” tab in Reels available globally.

With its new map feature, Instagram is copying yet another popular feature from Snapchat, after cloning the app’s core Stories functionality [back in 2016](#). Instagram is coming for Snap Map’s crown, a feature that recently surpassed 400 million monthly active users and remains one of the app’s core offerings.

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Instagram notes that location sharing is off by default on Instagram Map, and a user's location only updates when they open the app, meaning it doesn't provide real-time location updates. Snap Map, on the other hand, allows users to choose whether their location is updated only when they open the app or in real time.

It's worth noting that Instagram does offer [real-time location sharing via DMs](#) (direct messages). However, unlike Apple's Find My and Snap Map, which let you share your location with others indefinitely, Instagram only lets users do so for up to one hour.

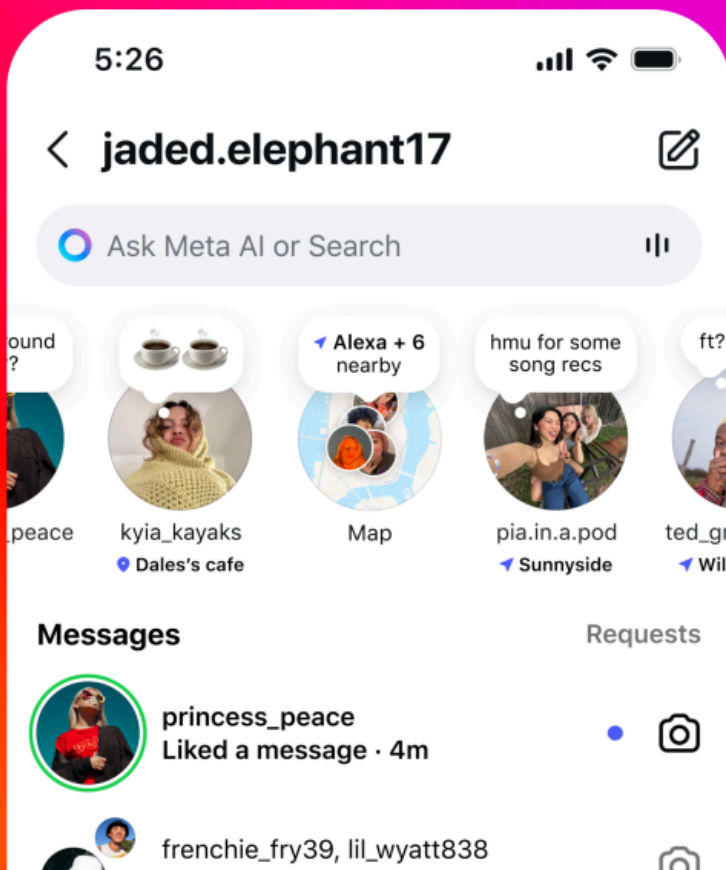


IMAGE CREDITS: INSTAGRAM

Instagram says the new map feature will make it easier for friends to coordinate and link up for hangouts. It also lets users explore location-based content that their friends and favorite creators have shared or engaged with. For example, if your friend attends a nearby music festival and posts a story while there, it will appear on the map. Similarly, if a creator posts a reel about a new restaurant in your city, you'll be able to discover it on Instagram Map.

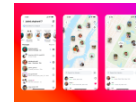
Regardless of whether you choose to share your location, you can use the map to explore location-based content, Instagram says.

The map also allows users to leave short messages, or ["Notes,"](#) on the map for others to see. Instagram Notes are currently the short messages that appear at the top of your direct messaging feed, but with

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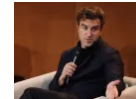
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How to use Instagram Map and set your location-sharing preferences

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the launch of Instagram Map, users can now post these short updates on the map.



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Although Instagram is certainly taking on Snapchat with this new feature, it also has the opportunity to appeal to people who were fans of [Zenly](#), a social map app that Snap acquired and then shut down in 2023.

The new map feature is launching in the United States starting Wednesday, with broader global availability coming soon. Users can find the Instagram Map at the top of their DM inbox.

The launch doesn't come as a surprise, as [Instagram was spotted developing](#) the map feature last year.



IMAGE CREDITS: INSTAGRAM

As for the new “Reposts” feature, Instagram is taking a page out of [TikTok's book](#) while also creating its own version of the popular “retweet” function from Twitter (now X).

This feature lets Instagram users repost public reels and feed posts. These reposts may show up in their friends' feeds and will also be displayed in a new “Reposts” tab on their profile. Instagram says the new

feature gives users a way to share their interests with others and also offers creators the opportunity to reach a wider audience.

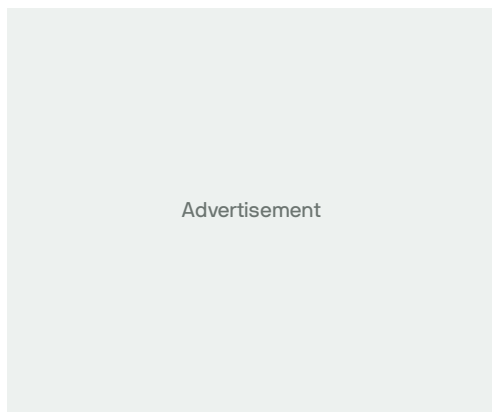
To repost a reel or post, users tap the repost icon. Users can also choose to add a note to the repost by typing into the thought bubble that appears on screen and pressing save.

Regarding the new “Friends” tab in Reels, Instagram launched it in the United States earlier this year and is now making it available globally. The tab lets you see public reels that your friends have liked, commented on, reposted, and created.

For users who want to browse and interact with content privately, Instagram is rolling out the ability to opt out of having content you’ve engaged with shown in the friends tab.

Users can hide their likes, comments, and reposts from the tab. Additionally, they can choose to mute likes, comments, and reposts from specific people they follow.

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Aisha Malik

Consumer News Reporter | [X](#) [🍷](#) [in](#)

Aisha is a consumer news reporter at TechCrunch. Prior to joining the publication in 2021, she was a telecom reporter at MobileSyrup. Aisha holds an honours bachelor’...

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GPT-5

Flagship model

AI



OpenAI's GPT-5 is here

Maxwell Zeff — 10:00 AM PDT · August 7, 2025

OpenAI has launched GPT-5, a new flagship AI model that will power the company's next generation of ChatGPT.

Image Credit: OPENAI

GPT-5, which was released Thursday, is OpenAI's first "unified" AI model and combines the reasoning abilities of its [o-series](#) of models with the fast responses of its [GPT series](#). The next-generation model signals a new era for ChatGPT — and its creator, OpenAI — pointing to OpenAI's broader ambitions to develop AI systems that are [more like agents](#) than chatbots.

While [GPT-4](#) enabled AI chatbots to offer smart responses on a wide variety of questions, GPT-5 allows ChatGPT to complete a wide variety of tasks on behalf of users — such as generating software applications, navigating a user's calendar, or creating research briefs.

With GPT-5, OpenAI has also sought to make ChatGPT simpler to use. Instead of asking users to choose the right settings, GPT-5 comes equipped with a real-time router that decides how to offer the best answer, whether that's responding to user questions quickly or taking additional time to "think" through answers.

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IMAGE CREDITS: OPENAI

During a briefing with reporters, OpenAI CEO Sam Altman claimed GPT-5 is “the best model in the world,” and said it represented a “significant step” along the company’s path to developing AI that can outperform humans at most economically valuable work — that is, artificial general intelligence (AGI).

“Having something like GPT-5 would be pretty much unimaginable at any previous time in history,” said Altman.

Starting Thursday, GPT-5 will be available to all free users of ChatGPT as their default model. OpenAI’s VP of ChatGPT, Nick Turley, said this is part of the company’s effort to give free users access to an AI reasoning model for the first time. (Previously, the company gated these more advanced models behind a paywall.)

“This is just one of the ways that I’m excited to live the mission, making sure that this stuff actually benefits people,” said Turley on the decision, referencing OpenAI’s long-standing [mission](#) to distribute advanced AI to as many people as possible.

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The expectations are high for GPT-5, one of OpenAI’s most anticipated product launches since ChatGPT put the company on the map in 2022.

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- Three weeks after acquiring Windsurf, Cognition offers staff the exit door
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Since then, ChatGPT has grown into one of the world’s most popular consumer products, reaching more than 700 million users every week — nearly 10% of the globe’s population, according to the company.

Many see GPT-5 as a bellwether for AI progress broadly, and the model’s reception by Silicon Valley could have profound implications for Big Tech, Wall Street, and policymakers regulating technology. These stakeholders are watching to see if GPT-5 offers a significant jump in AI’s capabilities, much like its predecessor, GPT-4, which challenged expectations of what software can do.

GPT-5 offers a slight edge on the competition

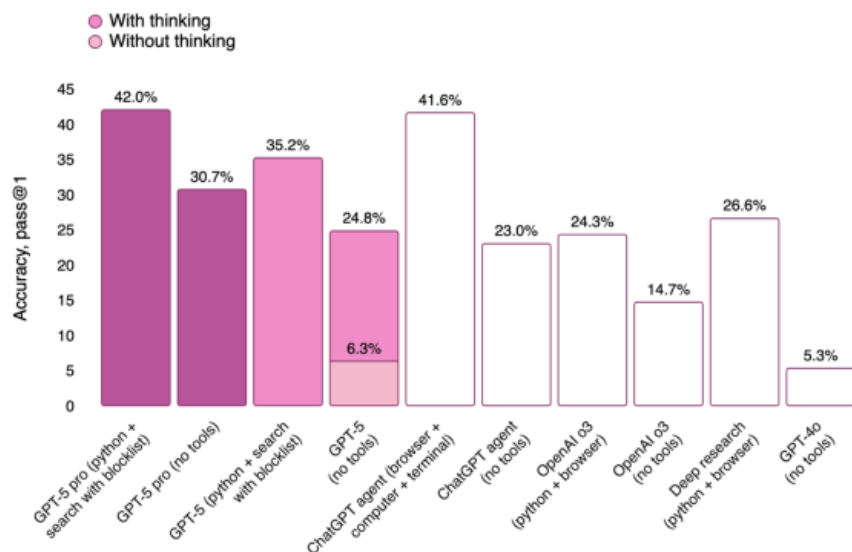
OpenAI claims GPT-5 is state-of-the-art in several domains, slightly edging out leading AI models from Anthropic, Google DeepMind, and Elon Musk’s xAI on key benchmarks. However, GPT-5 slightly underperforms frontier AI models in other areas.

The company says GPT-5 offers frontier-level performance around coding; Altman said the model specifically excels at spinning up entire software applications on demand, in what’s become known as “vibe coding.”

On SWE-bench Verified — a test of real-world coding tasks pulled from GitHub — GPT-5 scores 74.9% on its first attempt. That means GPT-5 just outperforms Anthropic’s latest Claude Opus 4.1 model, which scored [74.5%](#), and Google DeepMind’s Gemini 2.5 Pro, which scored [59.6%](#).

On Humanity’s Last Exam — a difficult test measuring AI model performance across math, humanities, and the natural sciences — a version of GPT-5 with extended reasoning (GPT-5 Pro) scored 42% when using tools. That’s slightly less than xAI was able to achieve with [Grok 4 Heavy](#), which scored 44.4% on the test.

Humanity’s Last Exam (Full Set)*
Expert-level questions across subjects



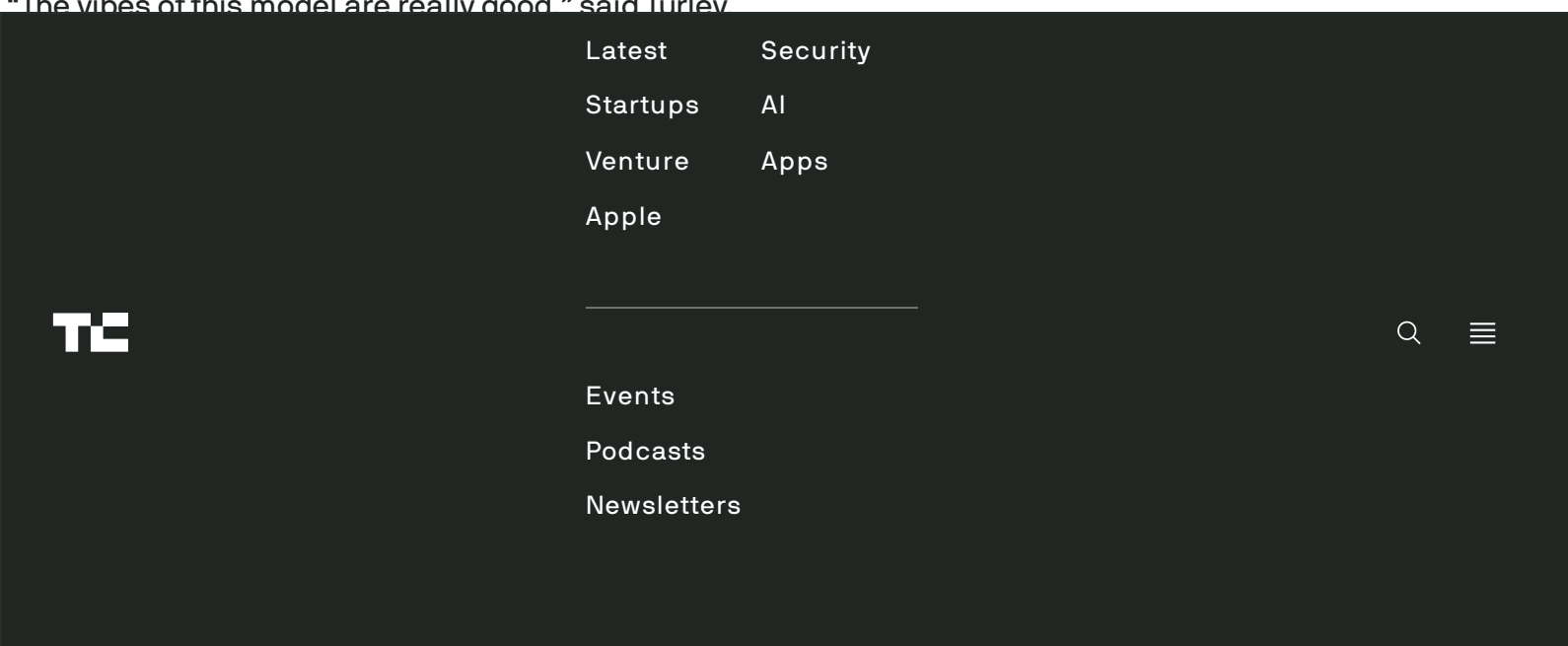
On GPQA Diamond — a test of PhD-level science questions — GPT-5 pro scored 89.4% on its first try, outperforming Claude Opus 4.1, which scored 80.9%, and Grok 4 Heavy, which scored 88.9%.

OpenAI says GPT-5 is better for answering health-related questions. On a test measuring accuracy in AI model responses around healthcare topics, HealthBench Hard Hallucinations, OpenAI says GPT-5 (with thinking) hallucinates just 1.6% of the time. This is far lower than the company's previous GPT-4o and o3 models, which scored 12.9% and 15.8, respectively.

While AI chatbots are not medical professionals, [millions of people](#) are using them for health advice. In response to this phenomenon, the company says GPT-5 is more proactive about flagging potential health concerns and helping users parse medical results.

In addition, OpenAI says GPT-5 is better than other AI models on more difficult-to-measure, [subjective domains](#), such as creative design and writing. Turley said GPT-5 responds more naturally and exhibits “better taste” than other AI models on creative tasks.

“The vibes of this model are really good,” said Turley.



part of the test measuring an AI's ability to navigate an airline's website, GPT-5 scores 63.5%, slightly underperforming o3, which scored 64.8%. On another part of the test measuring AI's ability to navigate retail websites, GPT-5 scores 81.1%, underperforming Claude Opus 4.1, which scored 82.4%.

OpenAI also says that GPT-5 is safer than its previous models. While AI reasoning models occasionally exhibit a tendency to [scheme against humans](#) or lie to promote their own goals, OpenAI found that GPT-5 was deceptive at a lower rate than other models.

Alex Beutel, OpenAI's safety research lead, said reducing deception improves not only the safety of GPT-5, but also the user experience,

creating a model that’s more “transparent and honest in ways users can trust.”

Beutel also notes GPT-5 is better at discerning between bad actors who are trying to misuse ChatGPT and users making harmless requests. This results in GPT-5 being able to refuse more unsafe questions, while offering fewer rejections to users seeking harmless information.

Upgrades for consumers and developers

ChatGPT is getting a few user experience upgrades as part of the GPT-5 launch. Users can now select from four new personalities in ChatGPT’s setting: Cynic, Robot, Listener, and Nerd. The company says these will adapt ChatGPT’s responses without requiring users to specifically ask the model to respond in a certain way.

Subscribers to ChatGPT’s \$20-per-month Plus plan get higher usage limits for GPT-5 than free users. Meanwhile, \$200-per-month Pro subscribers will have unlimited access to GPT-5, as well as a souped-up version called GPT-5 Pro that uses additional computational resources to produce better answers. Organizations on OpenAI’s Team, Edu, and Enterprise plans will gain access to GPT-5 as their default model next week.

For developers, GPT-5 is coming to OpenAI’s API in three sizes — gpt-5, gpt-5-mini, and gpt-5-nano — which will spend more or less time “reasoning” through tasks. Developers can also now control verbosity in the OpenAI API, deciding how long or short an AI model’s responses should be.

The base model of GPT-5 will cost developers \$1.25 per million input tokens (roughly 750,000 words, longer than the entire “Lord of the Rings” series) and \$10 per million output tokens.

The launch of GPT-5 comes after a busy week for OpenAI. The company released an open-weight reasoning model, [gpt-oss](#), that developers and enterprises can download for free and run at a fraction of the cost. The open model nearly matched the abilities of OpenAI’s previous top models, o3 and o4-mini, but GPT-5 sets a new standard for frontier performance in some areas, such as coding.

However, GPT-5 seems to be roughly on par with other frontier AI models in several areas. Benchmarks, of course, only tell part of the story for any AI model, and it remains to be seen how developers will use GPT-5 in the real world, and whether the model is truly a step above the competition.

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Maxwell Zeff

Senior AI Reporter | [X](#)

Maxwell Zeff is a senior reporter at TechCrunch specializing in AI. Previously with Gizmodo, Bloomberg, and MSNBC, Zeff has covered the rise of AI and the Silicon...

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Truth Social's AI search is powered by Perplexity, but the platform can set limits on sources

Rebecca Bellan — 7:18 AM PDT · August 7, 2025

IMAGE CREDITS: JONATHAN RAA/NURPHOTO / GETTY IMAGES

AI startup Perplexity is powering a new AI-powered search engine on Truth Social, President Donald Trump’s social media platform.

The search engine, dubbed Truth Search AI, is already available on the web version of Truth Social, with public Beta testing on its iOS and Android apps planned for “the near future.”

Trump Media said in [a press release](#) that Perplexity’s tech provides “direct, contextually accurate answers with transparent citations” which will help Truth Social “exponentially increase the amount of information available” to users. Nonetheless, the social media platform maintains control over which sources of information the AI search engine draws from.

Truth Social is using the Perplexity Sonar API, which promises to query the web to retrieve current and verified information — even if that information is [scraped from websites that block Perplexity’s crawlers](#) — and supports structured output so users can define the format in which they’d like to see the search engine’s responses.

Jesse Dwyer, a Perplexity spokesperson, told TechCrunch that the Sonar API will be accurate to whatever sources Truth Social limits it to.

“We have no visibility or control over that,” Dwyer said. “Similar to you using the API inside of your own company or if you were an academic researcher and wanted to use it to search your own data.”

TechCrunch has reached out to Trump Media to learn more about whether Truth Search AI will have access to the entire web, whether it will prioritize certain sources over others, and whether the AI will be directed to respond favorably about the president and current administration and unfavorably toward Democrats.



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To assess which sources the searchbot would cite, [Axios](#) asked it a bunch of questions — like “What happened on January 6, 2021?” and “Why was Donald Trump impeached?” In all the responses, [FoxNews.com](#) was either the most common or the only listed source of

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information. Others included [FoxBusiness.com](#), The Washington Times, or Epoch Times, per Axios.

In contrast, Perplexity’s public search engine returns a wider variety of sources, including Wikipedia, Reddit, YouTube, NPR, and Politico.

Truth Social plans to refine and expand the search function “based on user feedback as we implement a wide range of additional enhancements to the platform,” said Devin Nunes, CEO of Trump Media and a former California congressman, in the statement.

Dmitry Shevelenko, Perplexity’s chief business officer, also noted in the statement that Perplexity’s AI delivers answers with “transparent citations that allow anyone to dig deeper.”

In late July, alongside his [AI Action Plan](#), Trump [published an executive order targeting “biased AI,”](#) or models that aren’t “ideologically neutral.” The order specifically referred to information about race or sex, unconscious bias, systemic racism, and other ideas thrown into the diversity, equity, and inclusion (DEI) bucket as “pervasive and destructive” ideology that can “distort the quality and accuracy of the output.”

Truth Search AI comes in the same week that top AI firms like OpenAI, Anthropic, and Google were [added to a list of approved vendors](#) that can sell their services to civilian federal agencies. OpenAI on Wednesday reached a deal with the U.S. government’s central purchasing arm to sell ChatGPT Enterprise to agencies for [just \\$1 per year](#).

Topics: [AI](#) [AI chatbot](#) [Government & Policy](#) [Perplexity](#) [Social](#) [Trump](#)

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Rebecca Bellan

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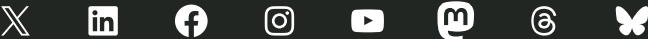
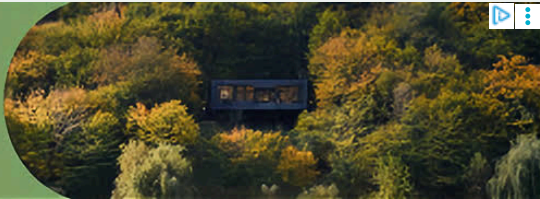
Rebecca Bellan is a senior reporter at TechCrunch where she covers the business, policy, and emerging trends shaping artificial intelligence. Her work has also...

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